

THE PROBLEM LENA DESCRIBED

Fill the gap. Keep one clear promise.

Last-minute cancellations create empty appointments and repeated checking.

Today

Staff check Square, scan a Google Sheet, text a likely match, and wait. The stopping point is unclear.

The failure to avoid

Two clients once said yes to the same group text. Different staff replied, and a client arrived expecting the slot.

Lena's goal

Fewer empty slots, less chasing, and one visible appointment holder. Square remains the real calendar.

Agreed approach: oldest eligible request first, one client at a time for each opening.

HOW THE PROTOTYPE BEHAVES

Offer. Wait. Resolve. Keep staff informed.

Each offer names the exact service, stylist, appointment time, and response deadline.

1 Add an opening

Staff enter the details and the last practical response time, allowing for travel and service length.

2 Find a match

Match service, availability and stylist. Exclude opt-outs. Offer the oldest eligible request first.

3 Wait up to 15 min

Decline or timeout moves to the next client. A question flags staff follow-up without reserving.

4 Confirm one holder

A clear, valid acceptance reserves the slot here. Late replies get an explanation. Staff update Square.

Staff can cancel an offer and try the next person, or close the opening and stop. Temporal retains the wait and outcome when the worker restarts.

VERIFICATION AND PROTOTYPE BOUNDARIES

Checked behavior. Clearly stated limits.

14 automated tests passed, plus a real-browser walkthrough on desktop and mobile.

What passed

Replies: acceptance, decline, questions, late replies and repeated clicks.

Queue: matching, order, client limits, timeouts, cancellation and practical cutoff.

Recovery: stop the worker, restart it, retain the original deadline, then advance once.

What is simulated or excluded

No real SMS. Buttons simulate client responses.

No Square connection. Front desk staff update it manually.

Sample waitlist; no staff login. Real client intake, opt-out management and access controls are future work.

A PRACTICAL NEXT STEP

Walk through a real cancellation together.

Lena and Carla can review the local prototype before any real-client pilot.

A focused staff review

1. Pick an opening and explain who should get it first.
2. Try a question, decline, acceptance and cancellation; check the visible result and Square handoff.
3. Agree on practical cutoff guidance and what staff need before using it with real clients.

Then prepare a small pilot

Add staff sign-in, live waitlist consent/opt-out handling, and SMS with safe retries.

Track openings filled, staff time spent checking, and conflicting claims against today's process.